

What optimisations are worthwhile for filter, partition, and tokenisation on GPU?

Lilje Henrich Due¹ Troels Henriksen¹ Cosmin Eugen Oancea¹

¹Department of Computer Science, University of Copenhagen

August 20th, 2026

Contact: due@di.ku.dk

Motivation

- Primitive Operations
 - Filter
 - Partition
- Non-uniform Data-Parallism
 - Hash Maps
 - Quick Sort
 - Segmented Reduce
- Pointer Structures
 - Expression Evaluation
 - Union-Find
 - List Ranking

Filter written in Futhark

```
def filter [n] 'a (p: a -> bool) (as: [n]a) : []a =  
  let flags = map p as  
  let offsets = scan (+) 0 (map bool.i64 flags)  
  let is = map2 (\f o -> if f then o - 1 else -1)  
    flags  
    offsets  
  let result = scatter (copy as) is as  
  in take offsets[n - 1] result
```

Filter written in Futhark

Example using an is even predicate: `as = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]`.

```
def filter [n] 'a (p: a -> bool) (as: [n]a) : []a =  
  let flags = map p as  
  let offsets = scan (+) 0 (map bool.i64 flags)  
  let is = map2 (\f o -> if f then o - 1 else -1)  
    flags  
    offsets  
  let result = scatter (copy as) is as  
  in take offsets[n - 1] result
```

Filter written in Futhark

Example using an is even predicate: `as = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]`.

```
def filter [n] 'a (p: a -> bool) (as: [n]a) : []a =  
  let flags = map p as                                [t, f, t, f, t, f]  
  let offsets = scan (+) 0 (map bool.i64 flags)  
  let is = map2 (\f o -> if f then o - 1 else -1)  
             flags  
             offsets  
  let result = scatter (copy as) is as  
  in take offsets[n - 1] result
```

Filter written in Futhark

Example using an is even predicate: `as = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]`.

```
def filter [n] 'a (p: a -> bool) (as: [n]a) : []a =  
  let flags = map p as                                [t, f, t, f, t, f]  
  let offsets = scan (+) 0 (map bool.i64 flags)       [1, 1, 2, 2, 3, 3]  
  let is = map2 (\f o -> if f then o - 1 else -1)  
              flags  
              offsets  
  let result = scatter (copy as) is as  
  in take offsets[n - 1] result
```

Filter written in Futhark

Example using an is even predicate: `as = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]`.

```
def filter [n] 'a (p: a -> bool) (as: [n]a) : []a =  
  let flags = map p as                                [t, f, t, f, t, f]  
  let offsets = scan (+) 0 (map bool.i64 flags)       [1, 1, 2, 2, 3, 3]  
  let is = map2 (\f o -> if f then o - 1 else -1)  
              flags  
              offsets                                [0, -1, 1, -1, 2, -1]  
  let result = scatter (copy as) is as  
  in take offsets[n - 1] result
```

Filter written in Futhark

Example using an is even predicate: `as = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]`.

```
def filter [n] 'a (p: a -> bool) (as: [n]a) : []a =  
  let flags = map p as                                [t, f, t, f, t, f]  
  let offsets = scan (+) 0 (map bool.i64 flags)       [1, 1, 2, 2, 3, 3]  
  let is = map2 (\f o -> if f then o - 1 else -1)  
              flags  
              offsets                                [0, -1, 1, -1, 2, -1]  
  let result = scatter (copy as) is as                [0, 2, 4, 3, 4, 5]  
  in take offsets[n - 1] result
```


Filter written in Futhark

Example using an is even predicate: `as = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]`.

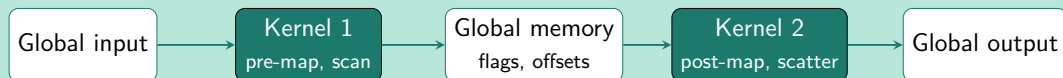
```
def filter [n] 'a (p: a -> bool) (as: [n]a) : []a =  
  let flags = map p as                                [t, f, t, f, t, f]  
  let offsets = scan (+) 0 (map bool.i64 flags)       [1, 1, 2, 2, 3, 3]  
  let is = map2 (\f o -> if f then o - 1 else -1)    [0, -1, 1, -1, 2, -1]  
    flags                                             [0, 2, 4, 3, 4, 5]  
    offsets                                           [0, 2, 4]  
  let result = scatter (copy as) is as  
  in take offsets[n - 1] result
```

Filter written in Futhark

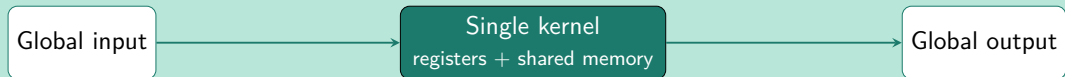
```
def filter [n] 'a (p: a -> bool) (as: [n]a) : []a =  
  let flags = map p as  
  let offsets = scan (+) 0 (map bool.i64 flags)  
  let is = map2 (\f o -> if f then o - 1 else -1) flags offsets  
  let result = scatter (copy as) is as  
  in take offsets[n - 1] result
```

Filter written in Futhark

```
def filter [n] 'a (p: a -> bool) (as: [n]a) : []a =  
  let flags = map p as  
  let offsets = scan (+) 0 (map bool.i64 flags)  
  let is = map2 (\f o -> if f then o - 1 else -1) flags offsets  
  let result = scatter (copy as) is as  
  in take offsets[n - 1] result
```



Filter written in CUDA



- Streaming Scan.
- Avoid global memory round-trip.
- Not the only optimisation.

- Many hand-written CUDA kernels.
- Baseline is a two-kernel implementation mirroring compiler-generated code:
 - Kernel 1: map + scan
 - Kernel 2: map + scatter
- Single-kernel implementations are compared against this baseline.
- Vary optimisations.

Hand-Written CUDA Prototypes of Filter

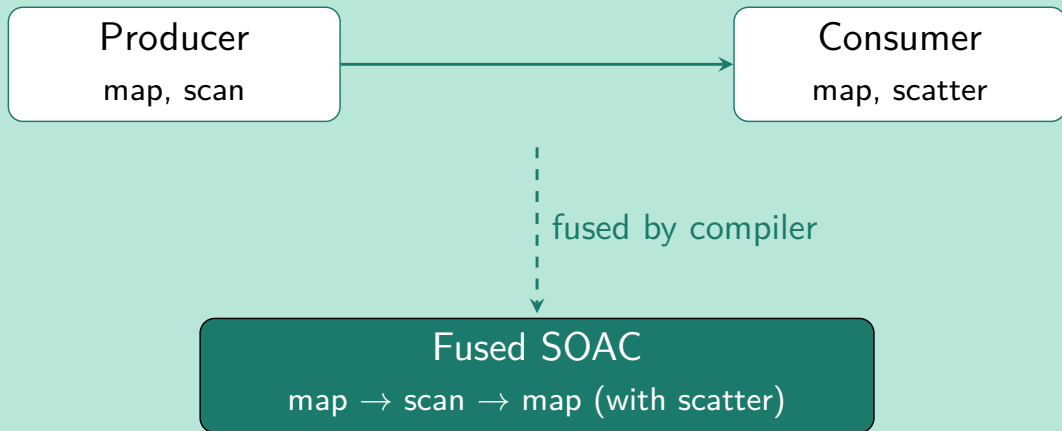
Relative speedup over **2K** baseline (higher is better)

Datasets vary by % of elements written: **Empty** (0%) → **Full** (100%)

Implementation	Full	Dense	Moderate	Sparse	Empty
2K (baseline)	1×	1×	1×	1×	1×
1K	3.5×	3.7×	4×	4.4×	4.9×
B	3.5×	3.7×	4.3×	4.9×	5.7×
CW	3.4×	3.6×	3.8×	4.2×	5.7×
FSMW	3.5×	3.8×	4.2×	5×	5.9×

2K: two-kernel baseline **1K**: single kernel **B**: bitsets in registers **CW**: coalesced writing to global memory **FSMW**: fewer shared memory writes

Fusion of IR



No source language fused primitive — only `map`, `scan`, and `scatter`, combined by fusion.

```
scanscatter  $f \ (\oplus) \ g$  as  $ds =$   
  let  $(bs, gs) = (\text{unzip} \circ \text{map } f) \text{ as}$   
  let  $bs' = \text{scan } (\oplus) \ bs$   
  let  $(is, vs, ss) = (\text{unzip}_3 \circ \text{map}_2 \ g) \ bs' \ gs$   
  let  $ds' = \text{scatter } ds \ is \ vs$   
  in  $(ds', ss)$ 
```


Accumulators

- Write-only array view; updates accumulate in place.
- Linear types.
- $[](\text{acc } \tau) \cong \text{acc } \tau$ — so `map` can take and return accumulators.

$$\begin{aligned}\text{with_acc} &: []\tau \rightarrow (\text{acc } \tau \rightarrow \text{acc } \tau) \rightarrow []\tau \\ \text{update_acc} &: \text{acc } \tau \rightarrow \mathbf{int} \rightarrow \tau \rightarrow \text{acc } \tau\end{aligned}$$

Scatter, expressed via accumulators:

$$\text{with_acc } (\lambda \text{acc} \rightarrow \text{map}_2 (\lambda i \ v \rightarrow \text{update_acc } \text{acc } i \ v) \text{ is } \text{vs}) \text{ ds}$$

Generalization of IR

```
maposcanomap  $f$  ( $\oplus$ )  $g$   $as$  =  
  let  $(bs, gs) = (\text{unzip} \circ \text{map } f) as$   
  let  $bs' = \text{scan } (\oplus) bs$   
  in  $\text{map}_2 g bs' gs$ 
```

Generalization of IR

```
maposcanomap  $f$  ( $\oplus$ )  $g$   $as$  =  
  let  $(bs, gs) = (\text{unzip} \circ \text{map } f) as$   
  let  $bs' = \text{scan } (\oplus) bs$   
  in  $\text{map}_2 g bs' gs$ 
```

```
 $\text{scan } \oplus \equiv \text{maposcanomap } (\lambda a \rightarrow (fa, ())) (\oplus) (\lambda a \_ \rightarrow a) as$ 
```

Generalization of IR

```
maposcanomap  $f$  ( $\oplus$ )  $g$   $as$  =  
  let  $(bs, gs) = (\text{unzip} \circ \text{map } f) as$   
  let  $bs' = \text{scan } (\oplus) bs$   
  in  $\text{map}_2 g bs' gs$ 
```

```
 $\text{scan } \oplus \equiv \text{maposcanomap } (\lambda a \rightarrow (fa, ())) (\oplus) (\lambda a \_ \rightarrow a) as$ 
```

```
 $\text{map } f \circ \text{scan } \oplus \equiv \text{maposcanomap } f (\oplus) (\lambda a b \rightarrow (a, b)) as$ 
```

Results: Filter

Method	Full	Dense	Moderate	Sparse	Empty
Old Futhark	1×	1×	1×	1×	1×
New Futhark	3.5×	3.6×	4×	4.4×	4.5×

Method	Full	Dense	Moderate	Sparse	Empty
New Futhark	1×	1×	1×	1×	1×
CUB	1×	1.1×	1.1×	1.2×	1.2×

Results: Partition

Method	Full	Dense	Moderate	Sparse	Empty
Old Futhark	1×	1×	1×	1×	1×
New Futhark	2.5×	2.6×	2.6×	2.6×	2.3×

Method	Full	Dense	Moderate	Sparse	Empty
New Futhark	1×	1×	1×	1×	1×
CUB	1.4×	1.4×	1.4×	1.4×	1.4×

Results: Tokenizer

Method	Dense	Moderate	Sparse
Old Futhark	1×	1×	1×
New Futhark	1.6×	1.8×	2×

Method	Dense	Moderate	Sparse
New Futhark	1×	1×	1×
2K	1.8×	1.2×	1.1×

- Simulates DFA.
- Determines location and token type.

Conclusion

- Review of hand-written optimisations.
- A simple language extension that generalizes fusion.
- High-level programs become competitive to hand-written code.

Benchmarks



Futhark

